

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Owner for API-driven B2B platforms.*

Positioning, ten years owning complex B2B SaaS products, with hands-on API platform depth and fluency in both engineering rooms and C-level conversations.

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§ WHY THIS ROLE

The posting names exactly the combination that is rare to find in one person: someone who can hold product responsibility for an API-driven platform while being equally credible with engineering teams and VP-level stakeholders. The explicit call-out of REST, gRPC, and API-Gateway concepts alongside multi-tenant architecture and regulated domain onboarding describes environments I have navigated repeatedly – in defence tech, public sector analytics, and InsurTech. What makes this particularly interesting is the B2B SaaS context with cross-functional Scrum teams at a 50 % cadence, which is exactly the operating model where structured backlog discipline and clear discovery formats pay off fastest. *That is the environment where clarity of requirements creates disproportionate delivery speed.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting, edge-case generation, stakeholder documents
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo support and spec review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, development-adjacent product work
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for concept validation
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframing and stakeholder presentations
- **Gamma.app**, structured discovery and workshop decks
- **n8n**, agentic workflow prototyping and automation

- **GPT**, research synthesis and user story refinement

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps rollout pipelines, OpenShift, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, JavaScript, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Redpanda, Argo Workflows, CGM API integration, MicroStrategy, low-code insurance platforms.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT THIS COMPANY

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Conduct structured interviews with the engineering lead, one VP stakeholder, and one API consumer team to map the current platform's pain points, where the backlog is stalling, and which discovery artefacts are missing or untrusted.

WEEK 2

Triage and sharpen.

Run a single focused backlog refinement session, apply a value-feasibility-risk frame to the top ten items, and surface the two or three stories that are blocking sprint commitment due to underspecified API contracts or unclear acceptance criteria.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Own the first sprint end-to-end: stories written, dev questions answered same-day, acceptance criteria exercised in review, and a one-page stakeholder update sent to VP level without prompting.

I COVER LETTER

Sehr geehrte Damen und Herren,

die Ausschreibung beschreibt eine Aufgabe, die ich in mehreren Kontexten bereits übernommen habe: Product Ownership in einem API-getriebenen Plattformumfeld, in dem technische Tiefe, strukturiertes Discovery und die Fähigkeit zur klaren Kommunikation auf VP-Ebene gleichzeitig gefragt sind. Genau diese Kombination ist meine Kernstärke.

In meiner Rolle bei Rohde & Schwarz habe ich Produktverantwortung für eine KI- und Datenmanagementplattform im Rahmen des europäischen Verteidigungsprogramms FCAS übernommen. Die Plattform war API-getrieben, die Umgebung reguliert, die Stakeholder multinational – Architekten, Data Scientists, Backend- und Frontend-Entwickler, QA und externe Auftraggeber auf Programmebene. Ich habe Anforderungen eigenständig von der User Story bis zum GitOps-Rollout geführt und dabei Deployment-Zeiten von mehreren Tagen auf unter 40 Minuten reduziert. Das ist keine reine PM-Leistung – das ist das Ergebnis davon, technische Lücken früh zu erkennen, sie konkret zu benennen und dann aktiv zur Lösung beizutragen.

Bei der Emil Group habe ich in einer B2B-InsurTech-Plattform die Sprintdisziplin wiederhergestellt, ein aufgeblähtes 17-köpfiges Team in funktionierende Scrum-Einheiten aufgeteilt und das Vertrauen eines Kunden zurückgewonnen, der kurz davor war, das Projekt zu verlassen. Der Hebel war nicht eine neue Methodik, sondern wöchentliche Product-Workshops, klar kommunizierte Komplexität und konsequente Priorisierung. Das Ergebnis: Lieferstabilität, messbare Velocity und deutlich reduzierte Senior-Entwicklerabgänge.

Für komplexe B2B-SaaS-Projekte mit API-Plattformarchitektur – inklusive REST, gRPC-Konzepten und API-Gateway-Logik – bringe ich darüber hinaus Erfahrung mit containerisierten Umgebungen (Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD) sowie Multi-Tenant-Architekturen mit. Ich kann API-Verträge lesen, Backlog-Items auf Machbarkeitsrisiken prüfen und Anforderungen schreiben, bei denen Entwickler nicht dreimal nachfragen müssen.

Das Projekt läuft bis Ende Q1 2027, startet im September und ist Remote-first mit Präsenzterminen in Köln – das passt gut zu meiner aktuellen Verfügbarkeit und Arbeitsweise. Ich freue mich über ein kurzes Kennenlerngespräch.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Technical Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience in API-driven platforms, regulated environments, and cross-functional B2B SaaS delivery. Has led

product ownership across defence tech, public sector analytics, InsurTech, and healthcare, always combining deep technical fluency with structured stakeholder communication. Comfortable translating complex API architectures and infrastructure constraints into actionable backlogs and clear sprint commitments. Operates at the intersection of engineering teams and C-level stakeholders without losing precision at either end.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Backlog ownership in API-driven, multi-tenant B2B SaaS platforms
 - REST and API-Gateway concepts translated into concrete product requirements
 - Cross-functional Scrum facilitation, team restructuring, sprint discipline
 - Structured discovery formats and VP/C-level stakeholder communication
 - Regulated domain onboarding with fast ramp-up track record
 - Technical fluency: Kubernetes, Docker, OpenShift, CI/CD, GitOps
 - Requirements engineering from user story to acceptance criteria to rollout
 - Workshop moderation, both technical and executive
 - Self-driven, results-oriented, low-overhead operating style
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned end-to-end product delivery for an API-integrated, multi-component AI data management platform under the FCAS defence programme
- Delivered autonomous feature sets from user story and acceptance criteria through implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout via ArgoCD
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps pipelines
- Resolved infrastructure-level blockers in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature that had been pending from engineers for over a year
- Led cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA with multinational stakeholders
- Designed audit trails and data provenance for SafeAI and ExplainableAI compliance requirements

Tech: Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redpanda, Kubernetes, Argo Workflows, ArgoCD, OpenShift

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Advanced the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform serving regional labour market and demographic data
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes; managed major system upgrades and CI/CD standardisation with full test integration
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, replacing manual pipeline processes
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV) with responsibility for compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin interfaces

Tech: Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Kubernetes, Jenkins, Bitbucket

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Owned product delivery for a B2B InsurTech platform serving primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, brokers, and underwriters – reducing insurance product time-to-market from over one year to under one week
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline in a destabilised delivery environment; split a 17-person team into focused Scrum units and introduced ownership and deputy concepts
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices
- Regained client trust through structured weekly product workshops and transparent communication of technical complexity
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

Tech: Low-code platform, Java, HTML/CSS, Kubernetes, REST APIs

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Led end-to-end delivery of a mobile-first pilot app for hospitals across iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system (KIS) workflows via legacy API
- Managed a small team under tight deadlines with strict focus on highest-leverage features
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of legacy API and external database constraints

Tech: AngularJS, Ionic, Python, Kubernetes, CGM API integration

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner / Deputy IT Security Officer

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- Designed for sub-two-minute setup with no technical knowledge required; served as core differentiator
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer covering attack vector mitigation and product security posture

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Founded a group-based P2P payments product on a P2P backbone
- Owned PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Product later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE / ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Led migration of internal webshop to Shopware, including complex product catalogue and API integration
 - Designed customisable approval policies for a regulated insurance procurement environment
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§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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